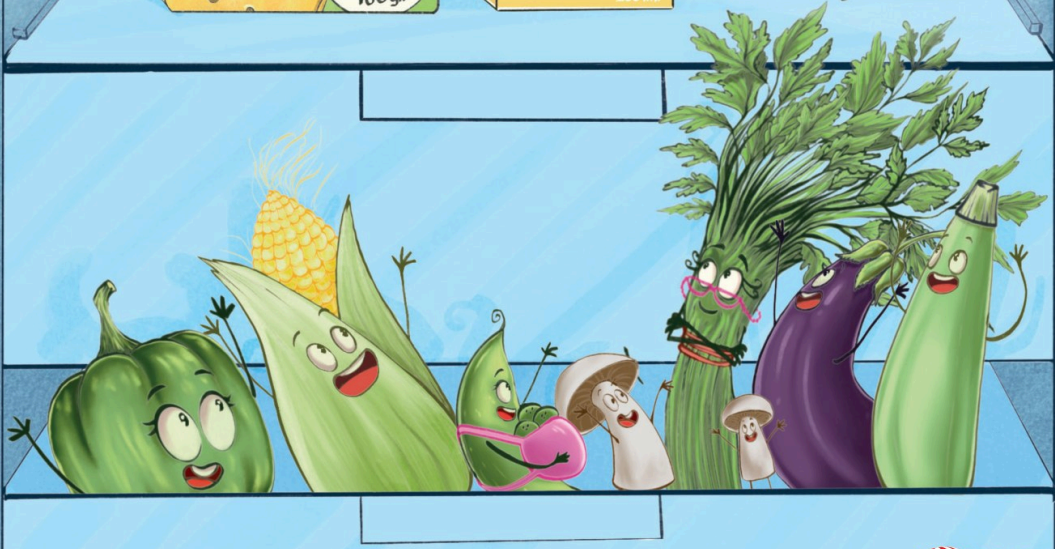
TOMATO WANTS TO BE A VEGETABLE







MASAL PEREST

TOMATO WANTS TO BE A VEGETABLE

Tomato Wants to Be a Vegetable
Esat Zorkirişçi

Illustrated By
Afra Elif

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Yayın Yönetmeni	Rose Mary Samanoğlu
Editör	Gökçe Uçak
Kapak & Sayfa Düzeni	Beyzanur Karabulut Koç
Sosyal Medya	Alper Kaya

ISBN: 978-625-6322-76-9
Baskı: Mayıs 2025

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ESAT ZORKİRİŞÇİ

ILLUSTRATED BY: AFRA ELİF

MASAL PEREST

Esat Zorkirişçi

He completed his education up to university in Gaziantep and graduated from the Business Administration Department at Celal Bayar University. He worked in various departments within the finance sector. His love of learning led him to cross paths with Creative Drama. While searching for ways to answer the question "How can I convey what I've learned to children?", he began writing children's books.

After many years in the corporate world as a white-collar professional, he decided to turn his white collar into a sail and travel through the world of imagination with children. He conducts workshops with children — whom he calls his "playmates" — in schools, museums, and open-air spaces.

Other books published by Masalperest Kitap: My Name is Earth: I Have Stories to Tell, Super Team: Cooking, Super Team: Cleaning, Super Team: A Sweet Adventure, and The Language of Love.

Afra Elif

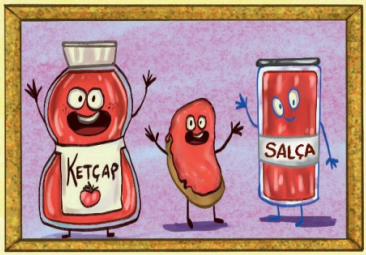
After opening her eyes to the world on a cold Istanbul morning in 1993, she eventually discovered pen and paper as she grew up. In 2010, she was accepted into the Cartoon and Animation Department at Dumlupınar University's Faculty of Fine Arts. She created her first illustration for a children's magazine in 2011 and began working in the field of children's books in 2013.

Afra Elif, who wants those around her to feel the same joy she feels while drawing, continues her life with happiness, and with her illustrations.

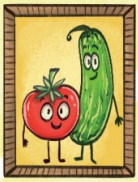
It was bedtime for the Little Tomatoes. But instead of sleeping, they were bouncing up and down on their beds. Hearing all the noise, Tomato Gramps came in and said, "Did you know? I was once just like you, little ones." But the Little Tomatoes didn't pay him any attention—they just kept bouncing and giggling. "I used to be full of energy, just like you," Tomato Gramps went on. Still, no response. "And I was... a tomato who thought he was a vegetable."







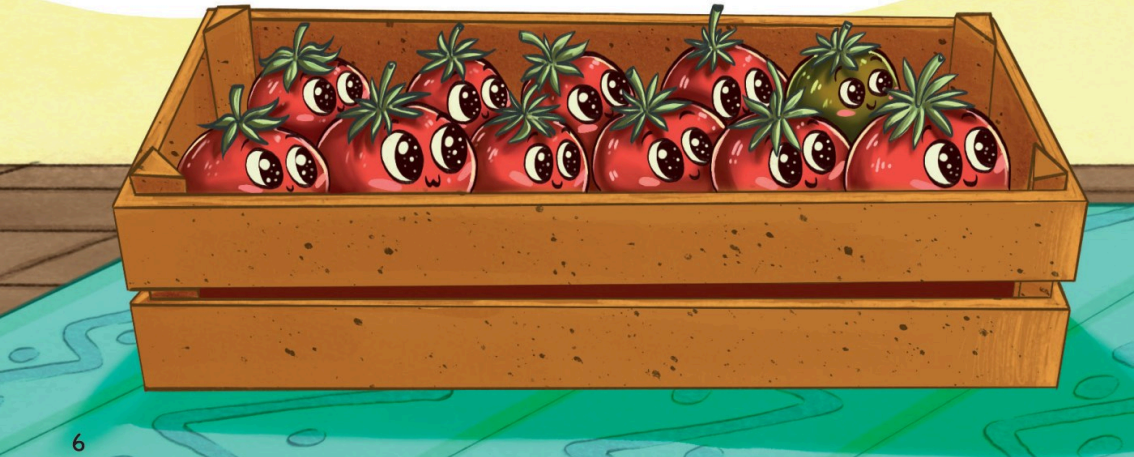




That did it! He had their attention now. The Little Tomatoes froze in place and stared at Tomato Gramps with wide, curious eyes.

"But tomatoes are vegetables," said the tiniest one.

"Is that so?" Tomato Gramps replied with a smile, peering over the top of his glasses.



Actually, the other siblings already knew the truth. But this little Tomato—new to the family and still green—hadn't heard the story before. The others had listened to it many times, yet they still climbed into bed with excitement. The small, green Tomato sat down too, puzzled but eager to hear what Tomato Gramps would say next.



"Of course, back then, my name wasn't Tomato Gramps. I was just plain Tomato," he said. "I was so young, so fast—you wouldn't believe it! I had just left the farm where I lived with my family and set off for the Land of Refrigerator to become ketchup.



I was the first tomato in my family ever chosen to become ketchup. Most of my relatives usually became tomato paste. So they were all very excited and proud to send me off on my journey. But... I didn't become ketchup. I didn't even become paste. And on top of that—I found out I'm actually a fruit!"

The Little Tomatoes giggled as if they were hearing the story for the very first time. "What? A fruit? Like an apple?" they laughed. "That's right. Like an apple... and even like a pear!"




MEYVE BÖLÜMÜ
SEBZE BÖLÜMÜ

"The refrigerator wasn't warm and sunny like our farm," Tomato Gramps went on. "I was standing at the entrance, staring nervously at the cold, glowing door... when I met your Uncle Cucumber. He had come all the way here to become a sandwich! Most of his family usually ended up in tzatziki, so they had sent him off with just as much excitement. The moment we saw each other, we became friends right away.

We handed our entrance tickets to the gatekeeper—Miss Parsley. She was in charge of everything in the Land of Refrigerator. 'To the vegetable section, please,' she said, and led us downstairs. The upper floor was for fruits.

